

HARD DISKS (SCSI)

SCSI drives are the best of breed in hard disk technology. Being the fastest hard disks on the planet, it's no wonder that SCSI is the interface of choice where performance and data integrity matter. The newest flavour of SCSI introduced this year was Ultra320, the seventh generation of SCSI sporting a bandwidth that will make your jaw drop—320 MBps!

As long as the system bus chugs along fast enough, SCSI performance improvements will certainly follow. Hard disks with rotational speeds in excess of 10,000 rpm will begin to replace 7,200-rpm models in the mainstream. Ultra320 should see the way for SCSI in 2002 as a high-end option for servers and enterprises. In fact, due to the high cost of implementing SCSI, it will most likely stay at Ultra320.



Seagate Cheetah
ST336752LW 36.7GB

*Mindnumbing data transfer rates and
low CPU utilisation*

This 15,000-rpm Ultra160 drive from Seagate is the fastest drive available right now. Period. The drive delivers performance which is faster even than ATA100 drives configured to run at RAID-0. With burst data transfer rates approaching 80 MBps, there is no other drive that even comes close to this one in terms of sheer performance. If you're a professional looking for top-of-the-line transfer rates for the most demanding data-intensive applications such as high-end audio-video editing and servers, this is definitely the drive for you.

+ Blazing fast data transfer rates
+ Quiet operation
Price: Rs 38,175
Contact: ACI Infocom Ltd

Phone: 011-6831878/79
Fax: 011-6831968
E-mail: sanjayv@aciinfo.com
Reviewed in: December 2001

Worthy Mentions

Seagate Cheetah ST318404LW 18.4GB

+ Very stable performer with commendable performance characteristics
+ Silent operation
Price: Rs 13,500
Contact: ACI Infocom Ltd
Phone: 011-6831878/79
Fax: 011-6831968
E-mail: sanjayv@aciinfo.com
Reviewed in: May 2001

Seagate Cheetah ST336704LW 36.7GB

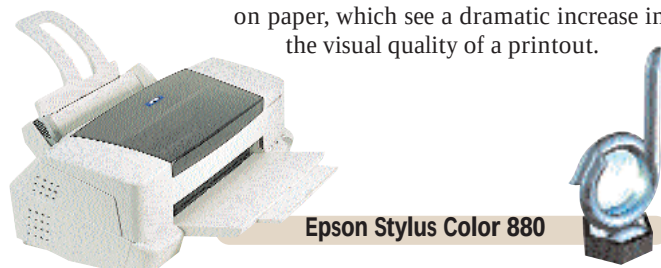
+ Good blend of storage capacity and performance
Price: Rs 27,500
Contact: ACI Infocom Ltd
Phone: 011-6831878/79
Fax: 011-6831968
E-mail: sanjayv@aciinfo.com
Reviewed in: May 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Seagate Cheetah 18XL ST 318404LW 1999: IBM UltraStar 18XP DGHS 1998: Seagate Cheetah ST391021c

INKJET PRINTERS

Image quality is the name of the game and the difference between inkjet output and photographs is almost undecipherable. The higher the dpi (dots per inch) of an inkjet printer, the better the output. We now have inkjet printers capable of reproducing images at a staggering 2880 dpi. Thanks to increased accuracy in colour reproduction, finer ink droplets and quicker print engines, inkjet printers today can even rival the quality and speed of more expensive laser printers.

Currently, special quality paper is needed to reproduce an image at high-resolution. Research is underway that would allow photo-like images to be reproduced on ordinary paper. In the future, fabrication advances will allow for much larger print heads that not only increase resolution, but also have much higher printing speeds. Further developments will focus on creating water-resistant ink and squirting smaller drops on paper, which see a dramatic increase in the visual quality of a printout.



Epson Stylus Color 880

*The first printer that claims to give 2880 dpi on
premium glossy matt paper. It gives you great
print quality and colour reproduction*

The Epson stylus Colour 880, with its faithful reproduction of fine details and colour gradations, emerged the clear winner. The printer performed well in the speed as well as image quality tests. Its robust build quality will see to it that it performs well during extended use.

+ Very good colour reproduction
+ Good build quality
Price: Rs 21,800
Contact: Epson India

Phone: 080-5321266
Fax: 080-5581799
E-mail: sheetal@eid.epson.co.in
Reviewed in: March 2001

Worthy Mentions

Hewlett-Packard 990 Cxi

+ Fine reproduction of details
+ Automatic dual-side printing module
Price: Rs 21,999
Contact: HP India
Phone: 080-5216121
Fax: 080-5276802
E-mail: princy_bhatnagar@hp.com
Reviewed in: June 2001

Epson Stylus Photo 870

+ Accurate reproduction of features
+ Fast print times
Price: Rs 19,500
Contact: Epson Singapore Pvt Ltd
Phone: 080-5321266
Fax: 080-5581799
E-mail: sheetal@eid.epson.co.in
Reviewed in: June 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Hewlett-Packard DeskJet 930C 1999: Canon BJC-6000 1998: Epson Stylus Color 800